Kinesio Taping

Definition

Kinesio Taping is a type of rehabilitative taping invented in 1980 by Japanese chiropractor Kenzo Kase.

Based on the principles of Kinesiology, it is used to:

- Support acutely injured muscles.
- Rehabilitate chronic neuromuscular conditions.
- Reduce inflammation and edema.

Physiological Effects of Kinesio Taping

Concept

Kinesio taping is a taping technique based on the body's own natural healing process.

Benefits

- Gives support and stability to joints and muscles.
- Does not affect or reduce circulation.
- Does not limit range of motion (ROM).

Mechanism

Using the elastic tape helps muscles and other tissues by providing outside assistance while still allowing normal biomechanics of the human body.

Effectiveness

Works through activation of: Neurological system and Circulatory system.

Additional Effects

- Lifts the skin.
- Provides support for surrounding soft tissues.

> *This method stems from the science of Kinesiology, hence the name "Kinesio."*

How Kinesio Works

Pain Reduction

Kinesio Taping alleviates pain by: Microscopically lifting the skin and reducing pressure on neural and sensory receptors.

Lymphatic Drainage

Facilitates lymphatic drainage, increases interstitial space, reduces pressure on the lymphatic system, and allows lymph to drain more freely.

Skin Convolutions

The taped portion forms convolutions (wrinkles) in the skin, which: Increase interstitial space, reduce pressure and irritation, and help alleviate pain.

Circulation Effect

Kinesio® Tex Tape demonstrates the ability to: Increase circulation and facilitate lymphatic flow.

Bruise (Contusion) Application

Fan-shaped Kinesio® Tex Tape is applied directly over the bruise. Results may be observed within 12 hours of application.

Types of Taping Technique

1. Kinesio Taping for Support

Indications: Chronic conditions, Weak muscles.
Direction of Application: Origin → Insertion

2. Kinesio Taping for Acute Rehabilitation

Indications: Overused muscles, Over-contracted muscles, Acute inflammation, Acute pain.
Direction of Application: Insertion → Origin

Characteristics of Taping Technique

- **Material Properties:** 100% cotton, Latex free, Medical-grade heat-sensitive acrylic adhesive.
- **Elasticity:** Elasticity up to 30–40% from resting length. Applied with approximately 10% stretch.
- **Skin Compatibility:** Allows the skin to breathe. Thickness and weight approximate that of skin. Easily tolerated.
- **Functional Advantages:** Allows full range of motion, does not restrict movement, supports muscles, reduces fatigue, facilitates myofascial release, improves lymphatic flow, reduces pain and swelling.
- **Wear Duration:** Can be worn for 3–5 days without reapplication.

Uses of Kinesio Taping

Therapeutic Uses

Reduce pain and inflammation through neurological suppression, relax overused or tired muscles, support muscles during movement, correct muscle function, strengthen weakened muscles, improve blood circulation, improve lymphatic circulation, eliminate tissue fluid or bleeding beneath the skin by moving the muscle.

Clinical Conditions

Headaches, Foot problems, Muscular facilitation or inhibition in pediatric patients, Carpal Tunnel Syndrome, Lower back strain or pain, Knee conditions, Shoulder conditions, Hamstring problems, Groin injury, Rotator cuff injury, Whiplash, Tennis Elbow, Plantar Fasciitis, Patellar tracking problems, Pre- and post-surgical edema, Ankle sprains, Athletic injury prevention, Pinched nerves.

Kinesio Tape Procedures

Technique: Uses a special adhesive cotton tape applied to stretched skin.
Assessment: The practitioner:

1. Evaluates the patient's condition.
2. Determines the muscles involved.
3. Initiates treatment using a specific corrective application technique.

There Are 6 Current Correction Application Techniques

No.	Technique

1	Mechanical
2	Fascia
3	Space
4	Ligament/Tendon
5	Functional
6	Lymphatic

Technique Details

1. Mechanical Correction

Purpose: Provides positional stimulation through the skin.
Techniques: Using the base of the Y to provide tension; Using the tails of the Y to provide tension.
Tension Used: 50–75% of available tension (Moderate → Severe)

2. Fascia Correction

Purpose: Gathers fascia tissue to align it in the desired position.
Techniques: Manual positioning of fascia while tape holds the correction; Creating tension by "Jiggling" the tape to move fascia.
Tension Used: 25–50% of available tension (Light → Moderate)

3. Space Correction

Purpose: Creates more space directly above: Pain, Inflammation, Swelling, Edema.
Theory: Increased space reduces pressure by lifting the skin.
Three-Step Technique: Gather tissue manually; Apply fascia technique (Jiggling); Use tape to pull and hold connective tissue in place.
Tension Used: 25–50% of available tension (Light → Moderate)

4. Ligament/Tendon Correction

Purpose: Increases stimulation over ligaments or tendons. Stimulates mechanoreceptors.
Tension Used: Usually 50–75% of available tension. May use 100% tension if required.

5. Functional Correction

Purpose: Provides sensory stimulation to assist or limit movement.
Tension Used: 50–100% of available tension during active movement.

6. Lymphatic Correction

Purpose: Assist removal of edema by directing exudates toward a lymph duct.
Mechanism: Creates areas of decreased pressure under the tape; Forms channels directing exudates to the nearest lymph duct.
Application: Base of tape placed near the lymph node. Applied in a fan-shaped pattern.
Tension Used: 0–15% of available tension (No tension → Very Light tension)

Quick Memorization Table

Technique	Main Goal	Tension
Mechanical	Positional stimulation	50–75%
Fascia	Align fascia	25–50%
Space	Reduce pressure/swelling	25–50%
Ligament/Tendon	Stimulate mechanoreceptors	50–75% (up to 100%)
Functional	Assist or limit motion	50–100%
Lymphatic	Drain edema	0–15%

High-Yield Numbers

- **Invented:** 1980
- **Tape elasticity:** 30–40%
- **Application stretch:** 10%
- **Wear duration:** 3–5 days
- **Bruise improvement:** within 12 hours

